Proceedings of the International Symposium on Soil Health and Sustainable Crop Production

Volume 1

Edited by

Rotimi Alade

A demonstrative volume prepared as a LaTeX benchmark asset.

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Nature of this volume. This volume is a demonstrative publication prepared as a LaTeX benchmark asset. The symposium is fictional. The contributed papers, their field trials, sites and datasets are synthetic: every measurement is generated by a seeded computer program supplied with the asset, and no value reports an experiment carried out on real land. The papers cite real published literature for methods, definitions and context; those works are cited, not reproduced. The results in this volume must not be used as evidence about real soils, crops or farming systems.

Conventions. Quantities are given in SI units. Grain and biomass yields are expressed in $\mathrm{t\,ha^{-1}}$ on a dry-matter basis unless stated otherwise, soil organic carbon in $\mathrm{g\,kg^{-1}}$, and soil pH is measured in water at a soil-to-solution ratio of 1:2.5.

Typeset with pdfLaTeX, biber and makeindex.

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Editor's Preface

Soil is the foundation of crop production, yet its condition changes slowly and is easily overlooked until yields begin to fall. The idea of soil health treats the soil as a living system whose chemical, physical and biological properties together decide how well it supports crops, stores water and carbon, and recovers from disturbance. Measuring that condition, and managing land so that it improves rather than declines, is a shared concern of agronomists, soil scientists and farmers in every climatic zone.

This volume brings together six contributed papers presented at the International Symposium on Soil Health and Sustainable Crop Production. They were chosen to span the main questions of the field: how soil health is indicated and measured, how nutrients and organic matter are managed, how crops respond to different systems of tillage, intercropping and rotation, and how results from field trials are analysed and reported. Each paper is self-contained, with its own abstract and list of references, and each can be read and typeset on its own.

All trial data in this volume are synthetic, as the imprint explains. They were designed to behave like realistic field measurements and to obey the rules set out in the methods of each paper, so that the volume can serve as a faithful example of how such work is written, checked and published.

Rotimi Alade
Editor

How This Volume Is Organised

Structure

The volume is divided into three parts. The front matter contains the title pages, the contents, the editor's preface and this note. The main matter contains the six contributed papers, one chapter each. The back matter contains the list of abbreviations and the subject index.

The papers

Each paper opens with its title, a short title used in the running head, and an abstract. It then follows the usual order of a research paper: introduction, materials and methods, results, discussion and conclusion. References are listed at the end of each paper rather than collected at the end of the volume, so that every paper can be cited and read on its own.

Data, tables and figures

The data behind every table and figure are stored with the volume as tab-separated files. Figures are drawn directly from those files when the volume is typeset, and values quoted in the text are computed from the same data, so text, tables and figures cannot disagree with one another.

Abbreviations and index

Abbreviations are spelled out at their first use in each paper and are listed together in the back matter. The subject index points to the pages on which the main concepts, methods and measured properties are discussed.